

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Evolution, not a sudden creed

1556-73 -> observant Muslim ruler + Timurid/Sufi accommodation

1563 -> pilgrim tax remitted | 1564 -> jizyah abolished

1575 -> Ibadat Khana | after 1578 -> debate widens

1579 -> mahzar | 1581/82 -> practical/final public closure

1581-1605 -> private inquiry + translations + sulh-i-kul + discipleship

RULE: policy evolved; 1582 did not create a sudden mass religion.

MUST REMEMBER: Ibadat Khana (1575), Mahzar (1579), sulh-i kul and Tauhid-i-Ilahi belong to an evolving imperial debate.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Five layers of Akbar's religious policy

PERSONAL -> prayer, Chishti links, inquiry, meditation and tawhid
FISCAL-SOCIAL -> selected disabilities and coercive customs reduced
INTELLECTUAL -> Ibadat Khana + private dialogue + Maktab Khana
SOVEREIGN -> mahzar and ruler-centred juristic arbitration
GOVERNING -> sulh-i-kul, justice, service and plural patronage
DISCIPLESHIP -> small Tauhid-i-Ilahi circle around the emperor
DISTINCTION: overlap does not make belief, policy and ritual identical.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Ibadat Khana debate cycle

1575 BUILD -> Fatehpur Sikri; text links Niyazi cell and Anup Talao

FIRST PHASE -> Sufi shaikhs + ulama + learned men + companions

THURSDAY NIGHTS -> royal forum after state business

CONFLICT -> doctrine + legal interpretation + precedence + court status

AFTER 1578 -> Hindu + Jain + Christian + Zoroastrian + other voices

1581/82 CLOSURE -> public forum ends; private inquiry continues

CAUTION: no equal parliament and no certain surviving structure.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Interfaith encounter: influence is not conversion

BRAHMAN -> Purushottam/Devi + pandits | exposition/translation

JAIN -> Hiravijaya Suri | bounded animal-life measures

JESUIT -> Aquaviva/Monserrate + Gospels | missionary expectation

ZOROASTRIAN -> Meherji Rana | light/fire has plural genealogies

SUFI-ISLAMIC -> Chishti + tawhid + pir-murid continuities

METHOD -> encounter -> evidence -> bounded influence -> non-equivalence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: The debate paradox

ROYAL FORUM -> participants seek truth and imperial favour

DOCTRINAL CERTAINTY -> disagreement becomes sharper

COURT STATUS -> theology, office, patronage and precedence intersect

FAILURE -> no common creed or durable theological consensus

CONSEQUENCE -> clerical monopoly questioned; sulh-i-kul develops

VERDICT: dialogue failed as concord but mattered for statecraft.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Mahzar: scope before significance

TRIGGER -> qualified jurists disagree on a religious/legal question

CHOICE -> emperor selects an existing opinion

TEST -> welfare of mankind + proper administrative order

ORDER -> may be issued only without contradicting explicit Quran/hadis

EFFECT -> juristic monopoly narrows; imperial arbitration strengthens

LIMIT -> neither pope/prophet nor unlimited sacred legislation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Sulh-i-kul as a governing principle

IDEAL -> universal peace + justice + paternal public welfare

MEASURES -> tax relief + wider service + plural grants + worship space

KNOWLEDGE -> translation and inquiry weaken blind following

POWER -> emperor still defines patronage, punishment and inclusion

LIMIT -> orders vary by region; hierarchy and conquest remain

VERDICT: early-modern plural governance, not modern secularism.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Tauhid-i-Ilahi: neither mass religion nor nothing

TERM -> Abu'l Fazl: Tauhid-i-Ilahi | Badauni: both terms

ABSENT -> scripture + priesthood + congregation + mass mission

PRESENT -> selective initiation + shast + greetings + ethical conduct

FOUR DEGREES -> property + life + honour + religion

SCALE -> Blochmann about 18 high nobles; Birbal sole Hindu in list

FUNCTION -> Sufi-like loyalty fellowship around the throne

VERDICT: restricted discipleship, not organized universal religion.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Inclusion and coercion in one empire

INCLUSION -> 1563-64 tax change + service + grants + translations

PATRONAGE -> Khairpura + Dharmapura + Jogipura + diverse recipients

COERCION -> Chittor + rebellion punishment + ruler-centred discipline

SOCIETY -> ranked, patriarchal and locally mediated

IMPLEMENTATION -> imperial order is not proof of uniform practice

RULE: neither pure tolerance nor pure cynical control explains policy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Source triangle and evidentiary limits

ABU'L FAZL -> policy/kingship detail | panegyric legitimation

BADAUNI -> dissent and ritual charges | hostile orthodox polemic

JESUITS -> encounter observation | conversion-centred expectation

ORDERS/GRANTS/TEXTS -> specified acts | uneven enforcement/reception

MATERIAL SETTING -> planned court city | no certain Ibadat structure

METHOD: every claim needs source, purpose, reach and corroboration.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Din-i-Ilahi/Tauhid-i-Ilahi was a restricted ethical discipleship, not a mass religion with a population census.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: 2025 GS-I syncretism answer map

DIRECT PYQ -> 2025 GS-I Q2 | Examine | 10 marks | 150 words

THESIS -> layered imperial programme, not sudden new faith

PROVE -> 1563-64 + Ibadat/translation + mahzar/sulh + Tauhid circle

ANALYSE -> inquiry + sovereignty + plural governance + elite loyalty

QUALIFY -> source bias + hierarchy/coercion + uneven reach

ADJACENT -> 2020 Persian sources; primary owner Topic 24/07

KEY STATUS -> Mains has no objective answer key; wording locally verified.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Abul Fazl, Badauni and later historians supply differently positioned evidence that must be attributed and compared.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 17 final answer spine

DEFINE -> belief != policy != arbitration != encounter != discipleship

TRACE -> 1556-73 -> 1573-80 -> 1581-1605

EVIDENCE -> taxes + Ibadat + mahzar + translations + sulh + Tauhid

SOURCES -> Abu'l Fazl versus Badauni/Jesuits + order/material checks

BALANCE -> inclusion with coercion, hierarchy and regional limits

BOUNDARY -> Topic 15 succession | 16 administration | 18 Deccan

VERDICT -> innovative plural statecraft, not modern secularism/religion.